

04

Software Installation, Updates and Licensing

Application requests, install failures, upgrades, and licence assignment

Default priority: P4 Low (P3 if blocking critical work)

Target response / resolution: Respond in 30 min / resolve in 1 business day

Handled by: Tier 1 / Tier 2

Scope

Use this instruction when a user requests new software, cannot install or update an application, or reports a licensing error.

Related instructions: WI-03 Laptops and Peripherals, WI-09 Access Requests, WI-20 Browser and Web Apps

Common symptoms

- User requests an application not on their device
- Installation fails or is blocked by policy
- "Unlicensed product" or "trial expired" message
- Application crashes after an update

Information to collect

- Application name, version, and business reason
- Hostname and operating system
- Exact error message or screenshot
- Manager approval for software that carries a cost

Resolution steps

- 1 Check the approved catalogue.** Look in the software catalogue or company portal first. If the application is listed, guide the user to install it from there.
- 2 Confirm approval.** If the software is not in the catalogue, confirm the manager's approval and a licence cost centre. Send unapproved software to the security and procurement review process.
- 3 Check licence availability.** Look in the licence tracker for free seats. If none are available, raise a procurement request and tell the user the expected timeline.
- 4 Install through the managed tool.** Deploy through the endpoint management tool (for example Intune or SCCM) rather than a manual install, so it stays patched and inventoried.
- 5 Fix failures.** For failed installs, check free disk space, pending restarts, administrator rights, and conflicts with older versions. Review the installer log and retry.
- 6 Assign and activate the licence.** Assign the licence to the user's account and confirm activation. Remove the licence from users who have left or no longer need it.
- 7 Validate with the user.** Confirm the application opens, the user can sign in, and any key files open correctly.

Escalate when

- Software fails security review, or is on the prohibited list
- Vendor-side licensing or activation errors
- A rollout or update causes the same failure on many devices (possible major incident)

Resolution and closure

- Update the licence tracker and the device inventory
- Note the approval reference in the ticket
- Close after the user confirms the application works

Quick troubleshooting reference

Symptom	Likely cause	What to do
"You do not have permission to install"	User is not an administrator, which is intended	Deploy through the company portal or the endpoint tool instead of granting admin rights.
Installer fails part way	Low disk space, pending restart, or old version conflict	Free space, restart, remove the old version, and retry. Read the installer log.
"Product not licensed"	Licence not assigned or expired	Check the licence tracker, assign a seat, and sign out and back in.
Application crashes after an update	Incompatible version or corrupted install	Repair or roll back the version and report to the application owner.
User wants software not in the catalogue	New requirement	Send for approval, security review, and licence purchase before installing.

Suggested wording for the user

Open	<i>"Let me check whether we have this software already available for you through the company portal."</i>
During	<i>"This needs approval from your manager and a quick security check. I will start that now and keep you updated."</i>
Close	<i>"The software is installed and licensed. Try opening it now and let me know if anything looks wrong before I close the ticket."</i>

Good practice

Do

- Check the catalogue and licence tracker first
- Deploy through managed tools so software stays patched
- Record approvals in the ticket
- Remove licences from users who no longer need them

Do not

- Do not install from untrusted websites
- Do not grant local admin rights as a shortcut
- Do not use shared or personal licence keys
- Do not install unapproved software for senior staff without review

Worked example

A designer asks for a new image editing tool that is not in the catalogue.

Ticket note field	Entry
Issue reported	Requests image editing software for a campaign starting next week.
Checks performed	Not in the catalogue. Equivalent tool available with 3 free seats.
Cause	Request for new software.
Action taken	Offered the approved equivalent. User agreed. Manager approved a seat. Deployed through the endpoint tool.
Result	Installed and licensed within two hours. Licence tracker updated.

Frequently asked questions

Q. A user asks for a free tool they found online. What do we say?

Explain that software must be approved and checked for security and licensing. Offer an approved alternative from the catalogue, or start a review request.

Q. Can users install software themselves?

Only from the company portal or catalogue. Direct installs are blocked to keep devices secure and supportable.

Q. What if a licence has run out?

Check for unused assignments and reclaim them first. If none are free, raise a purchase request and tell the user the expected delivery date.

Analyst checklist

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Check the approved catalogue | ☐ Assign and activate the licence |
| ☐ Confirm approval | ☐ Validate with the user |
| ☐ Check licence availability | ☐ Ticket note completed using the standard template |
| ☐ Install through the managed tool | ☐ User confirmed the issue is resolved |
| ☐ Fix failures | |

Preventing repeat tickets

- Keep the software catalogue current and easy to search
- Review licence use every quarter
- Publish a short guide on how to request software
- Use automatic updates for common applications